unhappiest and happiest on twitter are small us counties, happier closer to big city or in north or west

Wednesday 5th August, 2026 20:59

1 Data

2 Results

first map of swb in fig 1

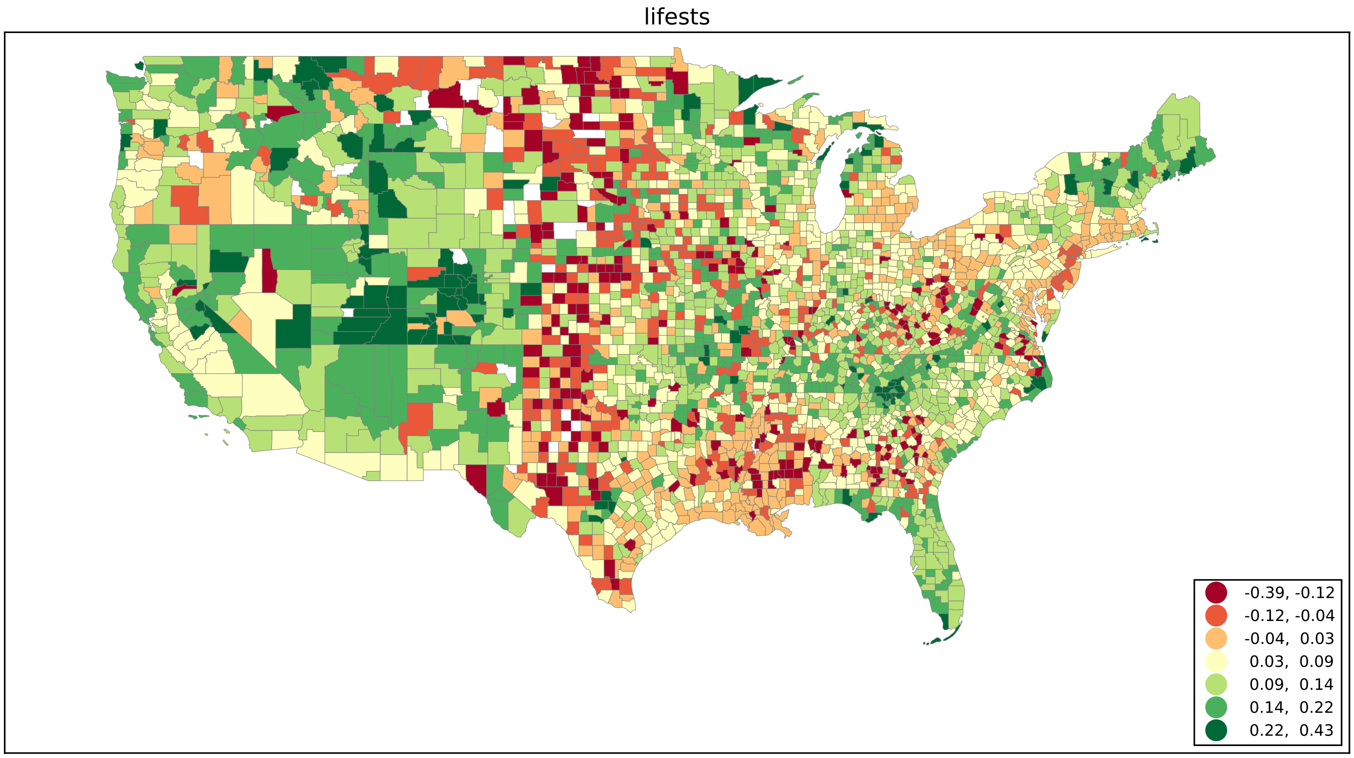

Figure 1

ha nj not happy; neither north east neither midwest, and then this belt from tx to north, and east of tx happy incl ca then pop siz, it is very right skewed distribution, hence we plot it without outliers dropping obs>1m 45 of them out of >3k obs (full range in app). it is slightly quadratic inverted u shape where it flips around 300k consistent with (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2017), but the difference here is that swb increases up to several hundred thousand, while in Okulicz-Kozaryn (2017) it doesnt[1]

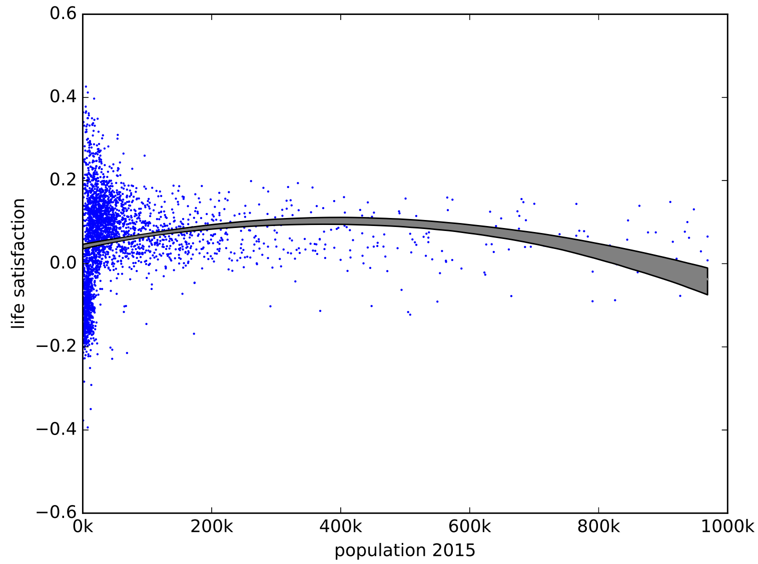

Figure 2: Quadratic fit with 95%CI shown.

next follwing "happiness ins in the air if it grows" (Okulicz-Kozaryn et al. 2024)– if happiness is in the air then should be on the tweet! in 3

here the relationship is much stronger even linear and correlation is about 0.2, while earlier with pop size was about 0

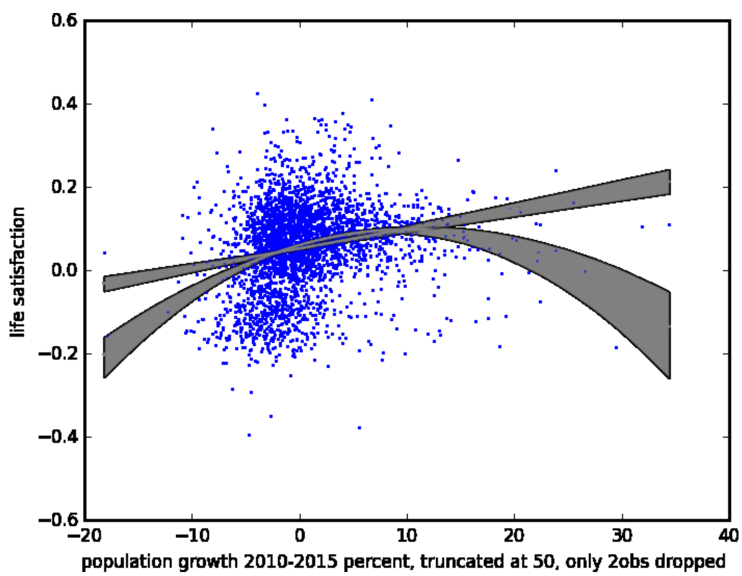

Figure 3: Linear and quadratic fits with 95%CI shown.

what was clear from earlier graph 2 is that happines extemes are for smaller counties. the point is made in figure 4. it begs a question what are they

[1]against pop den similar except inverted u shape is almost flat in app

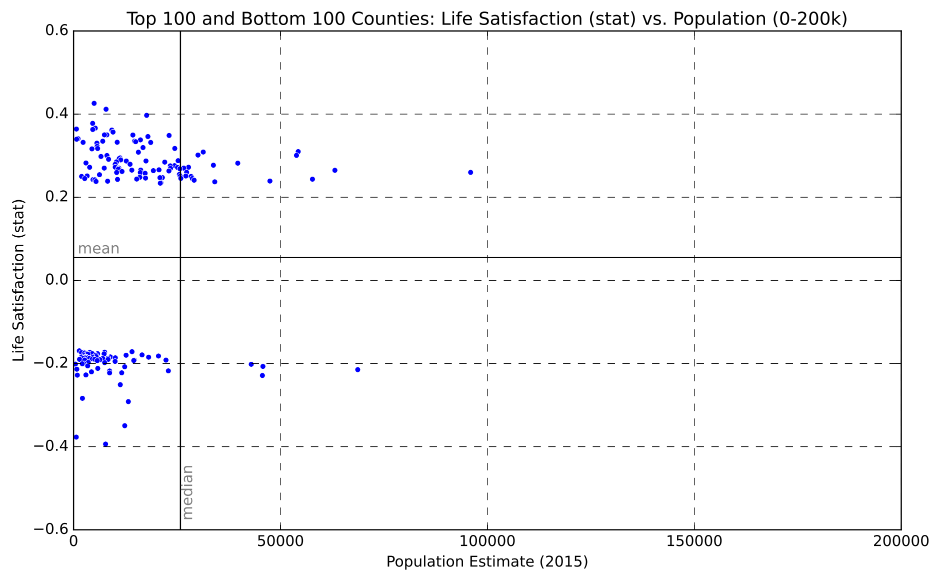

Figure 4

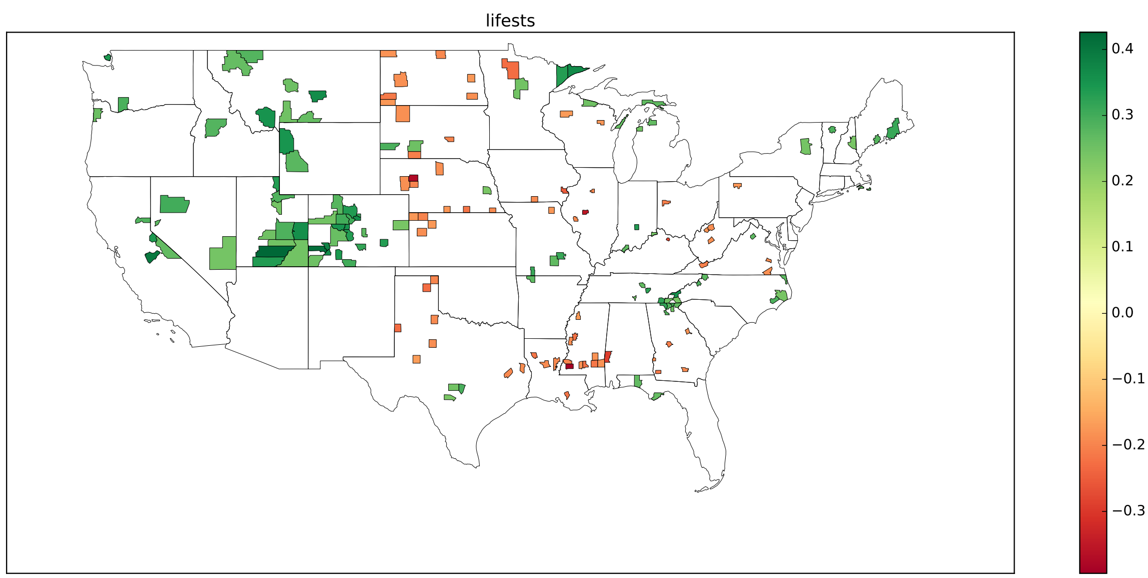

Figure 5

in topBotM there are interesting clusters of hi-hi and lo-lo indicating positive spatial autocorrelation, many span state booundaries

the happy counties are in Colorado(21), Utah (10), and North Carolina (8)

the unhappy ones are in: Nebraska (16), Texas (13), Mississippi (11), and North Dakota (9).

clear difference but Montana has 7 happy and 6 unhappy ones and Georgia has 6 happy ones and 5 unhappy ones.

we turn to borrowed size or positive effect of being close to large city: the higher the distance from a city larger than the one of residence of the respondent, the lower the probability of being satisfied with life **?**. we find similar patern in ???

driving distance is claculated between every county population centroid in the lower 48 and each major U.S. city with over 2 million people in its primary statistical area. [2]

[2]Data are from `https://github.com/jefferickson/county-city-driving-dist` and also see `https://github.com/jefferickson/county-dendist-map`

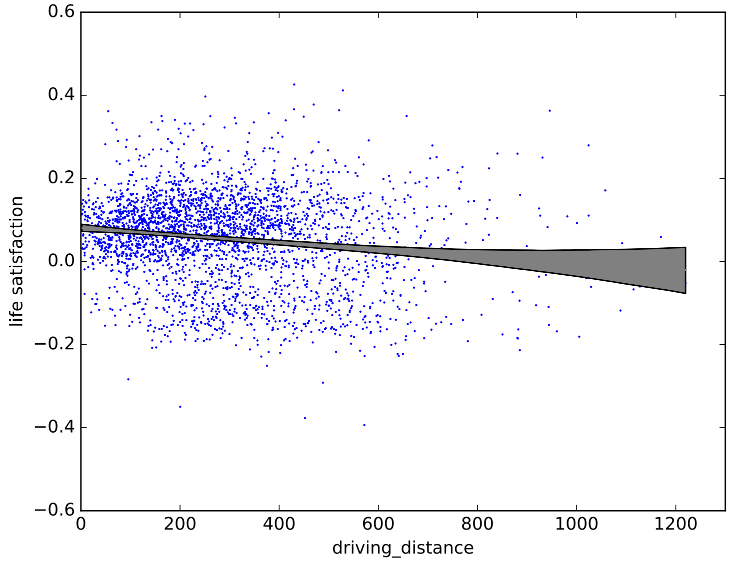

Figure 6

ONLINE APPENDIX

[note: this section will NOT be a part of the final version of the manuscript, but will be available online instead]

2.1 Additional results

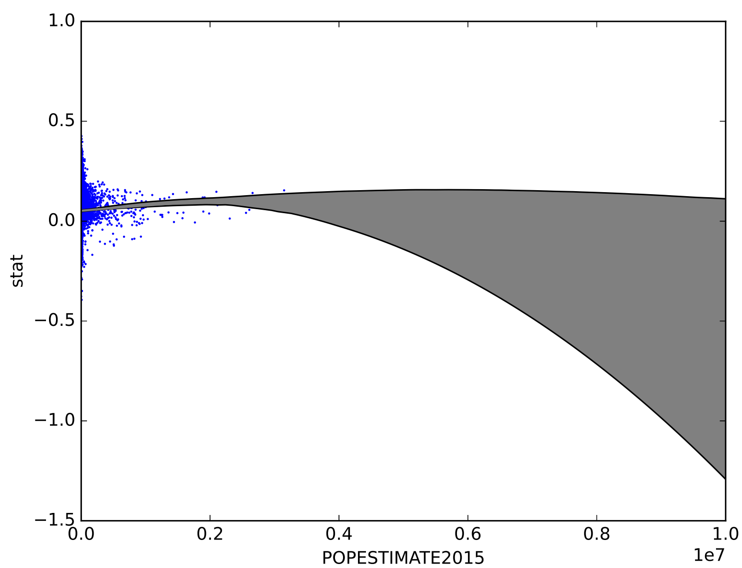

Figure 7: using all data on population without subsetting

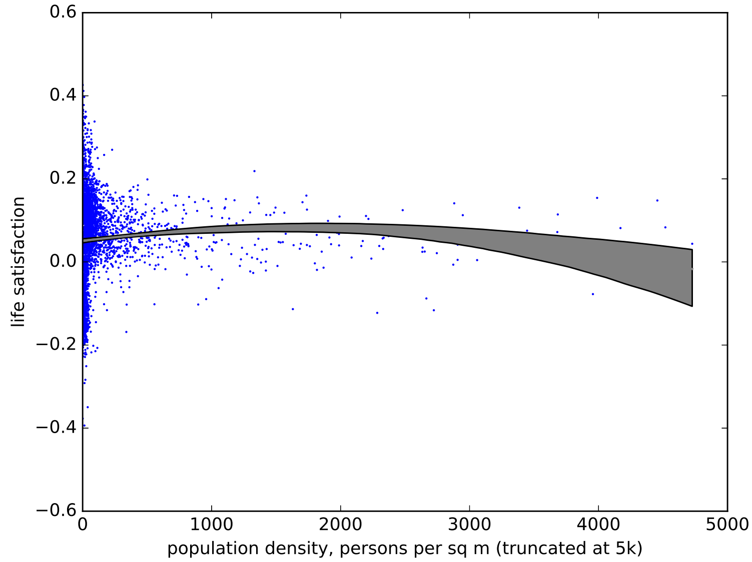

Figure 8

References

OKULICZ-KOZARYN, A. (2017): "Unhappy metropolis (when American city is too big)," *Cities*, 61, 144–155.

OKULICZ-KOZARYN, A., B. K. EVERETT, AND E. MIKHAEIL (2024): "Happiness is In The air if it grows growing places are happier than shrinking ones," *Urban Affairs Review*, 60, 1594–1613.